

ZERTIN ORAL SOLUTION

DESCRIPTION:

Clear, colourless to slightly yellow fruity flavoured syrup.

COMPOSITION:

Each ml contains: Cetirizine Dihydrochloride 1 mg

ACTIONS & PHARMACOLOGY:

Cetirizine, a human metabolite of hydroxyzine, is a potent antihistamine with a low potential for drowsiness at normal therapeutic doses. Its principal effects are mediated via selective inhibition of peripheral H₁ receptors. In experimental animals, cetirizine has been shown to be an anti-H₁ agent without any significant anticholinergic or antiserotonin effects. At pharmacological active doses, cetirizine does not induce sedation and behavioural changes due to the fact that it does not cross the blood-brain barrier. Cetirizine inhibits certain effects produced by exogenous and endogenous histamine. It inhibits the cutaneous reaction induced by VIP (Vasoactive Intestinal Polypeptide) and substance P, neuropeptides which are believed to take part in the allergic reaction. Cetirizine inhibits the histamine-mediated “early” phase of the cutaneous allergic reaction and also reduces the migration of inflammatory cells, eg eosinophils and the release of mediators associated with the “late” cutaneous allergic response. Cetirizine reduces bronchial hyper-reactivity to histamine in the asthmatic patient and the allergic reaction induced by specific allergens. These effects are obtained without any central effects being demonstrated. Cetirizine is rapidly and almost completely absorbed following oral administration. Absorption is very consistent from one subject to the next. Peak plasma concentrations are generally obtained within 1 hour under fasting conditions. The extent of absorption is not reduced by food; however, the rate of absorption is reduced and the peak levels are expected about 3 hours after dosing. After repeated oral administration, the daily urinary excretion of unchanged cetirizine is about 65% of the dose. The absorption and the elimination of cetirizine are independent of the dose. Its renal clearance is 30ml/min. The plasma half-life of cetirizine is approximately 9 hours. This value is increased in patients with reduced renal function. Cetirizine is strongly bound to human plasma proteins (93%).

INDICATIONS:

Adults and children of 2 years and above: symptomatic treatment of seasonal allergic rhinitis, perennial allergic rhinitis and urticaria of allergic origin.

CONTRAINDICATIONS:

Contraindicated in patients with known hypersensitivity to any of the ingredients of Zertin Oral Solution.

Cetirizine is contraindicated during lactation.

SIDE EFFECTS / ADVERSE REACTIONS:

There have been occasional reports of mild and transient side effects such as headache, dizziness, drowsiness, agitation, dry mouth, gastrointestinal discomfort, and hypersensitivity.

WARNINGS AND PRECAUTIONS:

Cetirizine does not potentiate the effect of alcohol (at a blood level of 0.8 g/L). However, care should be taken.

Activities Requiring Mental Alertness: In clinical trials, the occurrence of somnolence has been reported in some patients taking cetirizine; due caution should therefore be exercised when driving a car or operating potentially dangerous machinery.

PREGNANCY AND LACTATION:

No adverse effects have been reported from animal studies. As with other drugs, the use of cetirizine in pregnancy should be avoided, especially during the first trimester. Cetirizine has been reported to be excreted in human breast milk. Thus, it is contraindicated in women who are breastfeeding.

Use in paediatric patients: The safety and effectiveness of cetirizine in pediatric patients under the age of 2 years have not yet been established.

DRUG INTERACTIONS:

To date, there are no known interactions with other drugs. As with other antihistamines it is advisable to avoid excessive alcohol consumption. If sedatives are also being taken, cetirizine should be used with caution.

DOSAGE AND ADMINISTRATION:**Adults**

10 mg (10 ml of oral solution) once daily.

A 5 mg starting dose (5 ml of oral solution) may be proposed if this leads to satisfactory control of the symptoms.

Children

Children aged from 2 to 6 years

2.5 mg (2.5 ml of oral solution bid) twice daily.

Children aged from 6 to 12 years

5 mg (5 ml of oral solution) twice daily.

Children over 12 years of age

10 mg (10 ml of oral solution) once daily.

Elderly

Data does not suggest that the dose needs to be reduced in elderly subjects provided that the renal function is normal.

Patients with moderate to severe renal impairment

Since cetirizine is mainly excreted via renal route, in cases no alternative treatment can be used, the dosing intervals must be individualised according to renal function.

Refer to the following table and adjust the dose as indicated.

$$CL_{Cr} = \frac{[140 - \text{age (years)}] \times \text{weight (kg)}}{72 \times \text{serum creatinine (mg/dl)}} \quad (\times 0.85 \text{ for women})$$

Dosing adjustments for adult patients with impaired renal function

Group	GFR (ml/min)	Dosage and frequency
Normal renal function	≥90	10 mg once daily
Mild decrease renal function	60 – < 90	10 mg once daily
Moderately decreased renal function	30 – < 60	5 mg once daily
Severely decreased renal function	15 – < 30 not requiring dialysis treatment	5 mg once every 2 days
End-stage renal disease	< 15 requiring dialysis treatment	Contraindicated

In paediatric patients suffering from renal impairment, the dose will have to be adjusted on an individual basis taking into account the renal clearance, age and body weight of the patient.

Patients with hepatic impairment

No dose adjustment is needed in patients with solely hepatic impairment.

Patients with hepatic impairment and renal impairment

Dose adjustment is recommended (see Patients with renal impairment above).

ROUTE OF ADMINISTRATION:

Oral administration

SYMPTOMS AND TREATMENT FOR OVERDOSAGE:

Drowsiness can be a symptom of overdosage, occurring from administration of 50 mg of cetirizine as a single dose. In children agitation can occur. To date, there is no specific antidote. In case of massive overdosage, gastric lavage should be performed together with the usual supportive measures. Routine observation should also be carried out regularly.

EFFECTS ON ABILITY TO DRIVE AND USE MACHINE:

Patients who experience somnolence should refrain from driving, engaging in potentially hazardous activities or operating machinery.

Patients intending to drive, engaging in potentially hazardous activities or operating machinery should not exceed the recommended dose and should take their response to the medicinal product into account.

PRESENTATION:

Plastic (HDPE) bottles of 60 ml and 120 ml

STORAGE CONDITIONS:

Store in a cool dry place below 30°C.

Protect from light.
Keep the container tightly closed.
Keep out of reach of children.
Jauhkan daripada capaian kanak-kanak

MANUFACTURED BY:

Noripharma Sdn. Bhd. 200701034604 (792633-A)
Lot 5030, Jalan Teratai,
5 ½ Mile off Jalan Meru,
41050 Klang, Selangor

DATE OF REVISION:

December 2023